

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Dr Mahbobur Choudhury

Address: 14A Station Road Belmont SM2 6BH

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I have loved working and living in Sutton for almost 25 years, and I am very pleased to see this new proposed development which my family and I support without any reservations. Sutton is changing and becoming a wonderful place for people from diverse backgrounds working together to make a great community with rich values. The Council has a duty to look after the needs of the people who live and work in the borough. The muslim community of Belmont and Cheam have used St John's Church Hall for many years without any issues. Indeed, I booked the hall for an event some 20 years ago.

There is now a need for the local muslim community to have a purpose built, larger space for worship (including holding wedding vows), recreation, place for the youth to enjoy activities (social, sports, education) and a place to get positive guidance on life. The venue will also be open to non-muslims to attend functions and events.

The concerns regarding highway safety and noise levels are overstated. Fewer people will be attending the venue than attending the Avenue school. The times of attending the venue will not coincide with the opening and closing times of the school. Friday is usually the peak attendance between 1pm and 2pm. This attendance has already been in place for many years at the nearby St John's Church Hall, which is a more congested venue. Other times only a dozen or so people will probably attend and most like myself will probably walk to the site. The concern regarding noise is overstated. A simple visit to any such establishment in London will confirm this. The attendees are very peaceful and only soft drinks are allowed in the premises with no music allowed.

The site location for a place of worship is no different to residential roads in which most of the churches in the borough are located. The building design will add character and value to a site that has been neglected for a long time. I am sure any changes the Case Officer feels objectionable can be accommodated by the developer.

I hope the Case Officer will look at all the benefits this development will provide the local community and approve the application.